Building a Business While Earning an MBA

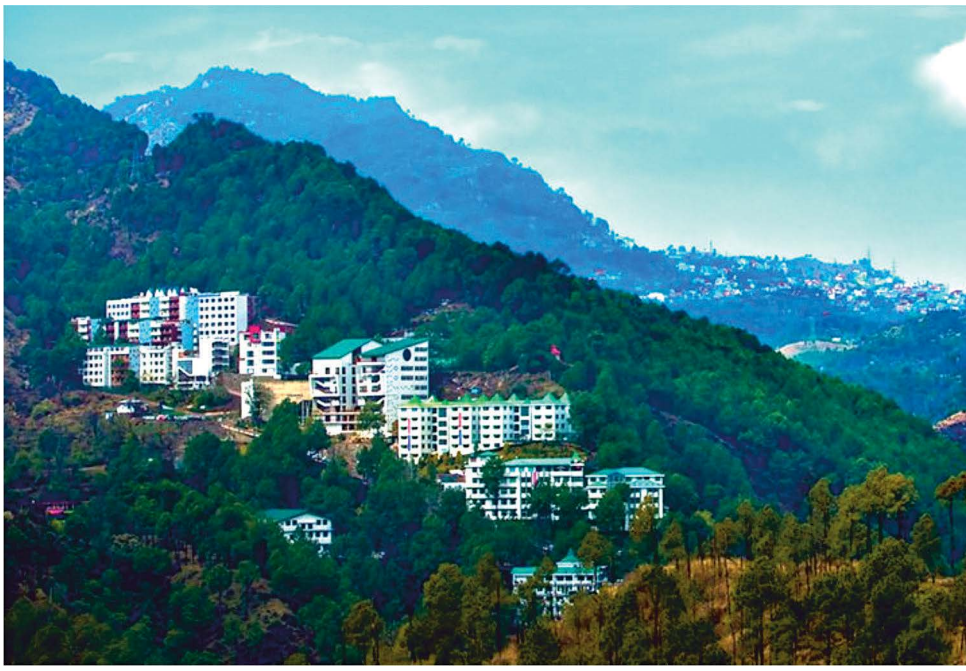
Shoolini connects management education with startup development and community enterprise, helping students understand what it takes to make a business work

Pricing a product, finding customers and managing limited funds test a business idea. At Shoolini Business School, MBA students tackle these questions from their first semester, working with researchers and engineers on market studies, prototype development and business proposals. They present their recommendations to internal and external panels, learning to question assumptions and explain their decisions while testing their own ideas.

Supporting this work is Shoolini's incubation network, which includes NIDHI iTBI, backed by the Department of Science and Technology, and ACIC-SU, supported by NITI Aayog. The Steve Jobs Innovation & Incubation Centre and iHUB Shoolini are also part of the network.

"We want students to learn entrepreneurship by doing. Working with campus innovators and women entrepreneurs in villages teaches them how to turn an idea into a sustainable venture," said Prof Vishal Anand, Pro-Chancellor, Shoolini University.

In Tikkar village, the Shoolini Pehal Foundation's Project Pragati supports rural women entrepreneurs with skills, equipment and business planning. MBA students help with branding, inventory planning and market mapping, accounting for owners' budgets and customers' purchasing power.



"Testing ideas and working with entrepreneurs teaches students to question assumptions and explain their decisions. They need that judgement whether they start a company or become managers," said Prof Atul Khosla, Vice Chancellor, Shoolini University.



Shoolini MBA at a Glance

- **Startup Support:** Four incubation and innovation centres
- **Startup Marathon:** Problem discovery and validation before pitching
- **Rural Enterprise:** Branding, inventory and market mapping through Project Pragati
- **Career Readiness:** Launchpad SPRINT, Stanford-inspired SPRINT modules and one-on-oneV- Empower coaching
- **Professional Training:** Banking, financial markets and process improvement
- **Global Exposure:** Semester-abroad options and international faculty interactions

TESTING AN IDEA BEFORE INVESTING IN IT

The Foundation's Startup Marathon takes students from identifying a problem to pitching an idea. Its fourth edition, 'Build What Matters', is open to all disciplines, including MBA students. During Problem Discovery and Problem Validation, participants test assumptions with people affected by the problem.

A separate track supports first-year students. Founders from earlier editions return as mentors, including some from the 36 startups the Foundation has backed since 2022.

PREPARING FOR BUSINESS CAREERS

As AI tools analyse data and draft business plans, students must check their accuracy and assess whether their recommendations suit a business. An assignment could involve comparing an AI-generated sales forecast with customer research before recommending an investment. The task is to explain whether the forecast offers a sound basis for spending money, what the customer evidence supports and where further checks are needed before a business commits its limited funds.

The MBA includes live projects and case studies. Launchpad SPRINT develops communication and career readiness, supported by Stanford-inspired SPRINT™ modules and one-on-one V-Empower coaching. Professional training covers banking, financial markets and process improvement.

Semester-abroad options and international faculty interactions offer exposure to different business environments. The National Human Resources Development Network connects students with industry professionals.

Students running campus ventures in fitness, consultancy and product innovation work with faculty and incubation mentors on costs, pricing and customer demand, gaining business experience alongside their MBA.

Shoolini University